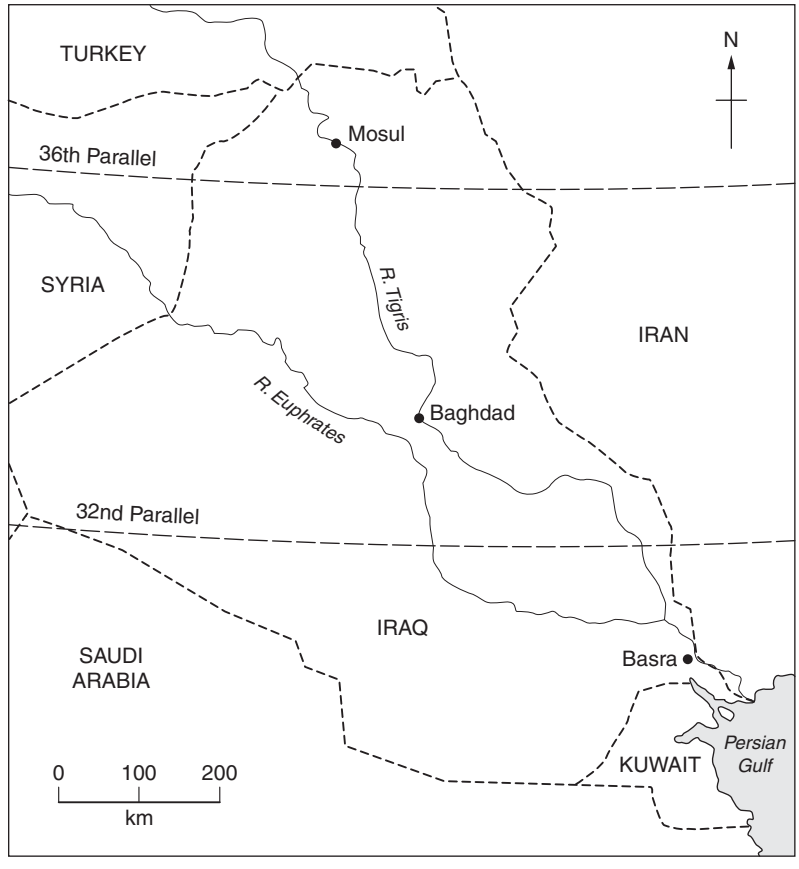
This map shows the latitude lines, the 36th and 32nd parallels, that mark the north and south 'no-fly' zones. North of the 36th parallel was the mainly Kurdish area and south of the 32nd parallel was the mainly Shia area.



Ceasefire, March 1991

The coalition forces stopped short of Baghdad. Their UN mission had been restricted to the liberation of Kuwait and the USA's Arab allies would not have supported an American overthrow of Saddam. The coalition would have split if the Americans had attacked Baghdad. Instead, a ceasefire was called in March and peace terms were imposed on Iraq by the UN. These included:

- recognition of Kuwait's sovereignty
- payment of reparations (war damages)
- imposition of 'no-fly zones' in the Kurdish north and the south (and, for the next 12 years, US and British planes flew over these areas preventing the Iraqi air force from doing so)
- Iraqi co-operation with the UN to uncover and destroy all potential for producing **weapons of mass destruction (WMD)** whether biological, chemical or nuclear
- agreement with wide-ranging trade sanctions (which virtually cut off Iraq from the rest of the world) which were to last until all WMD were destroyed.

Key term

Weapons of mass destruction (WMD) Biological, chemical or nuclear weapons, used to kill as many people as possible.